

THE EDIT ABROAD

London

The Luxury Packing Guide

MAYFAIR · NOTTING HILL · SHOREDITCH · CHELSEA · SOHO

WELCOME TO THE EDIT

London — A City That Dresses for Every Occasion

London has no single aesthetic — it has five thousand of them, one per neighbourhood. The quiet tailoring of Mayfair. The creative edge of Shoreditch. The polished ease of Chelsea. The bohemian charm of Notting Hill. The unpretentious cool of Soho on a Tuesday night.

What every neighbourhood shares: layers. London weather is famously unreliable — a warm morning can become a grey afternoon and a clear evening within six hours. The well-dressed London visitor plans for all three, every single day, without fail.

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In London, a great coat is not optional. It is the outfit.

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YOUR DESTINATIONS

MAYFAIR

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NOTTING HILL

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SHOREDITCH

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CHELSEA

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BEST TIME TO VISIT

London is a year-round destination. Summer (June–August) is warm and long-lit. Autumn is golden and beautiful. Winter is grey but deeply atmospheric. Spring is unpredictable and perfect.

SPRING

Unpredictable, beautiful, layered

SUMMER

Warm, long evenings, vibrant

AUTUMN–WINTER

Moody, golden, deeply stylish

Her Edit — London Wardrobe

Layered, considered, and ready for anything

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

DAYWEAR

Quality trench coat (the London essential) × 1
 Tailored wide-leg trousers × 2
 Silk or quality blouse × 2
 Fine knit sweater or turtleneck × 2
 Midi dress (lined, not sheer) × 1

EVENING & LAYERS

Well-fitted dark jeans × 1
 Blazer (structured, quality) × 1
 Casual but elevated T-shirt × 2
 Leather or faux leather jacket × 1
 Thermal underlayer (autumn/winter) × 1

SHOES

Ankle boot (leather, block or flat heel) — London's pavements demand this above all else
 Ballet flat or pointed loafer — galleries, afternoon tea, Notting Hill market days
 White leather sneaker (clean, quality) — Shoreditch, Borough Market, casual Sundays
 Heeled boot or block-heel sandal — Mayfair dinner, theatre, and West End evenings

ACCESSORIES

HEADWEAR & JEWELLERY

Wool or cashmere scarf (not decorative — essential)
 Quality leather gloves (autumn/winter)
 Structured leather shoulder bag

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Compact umbrella (non-negotiable)
 Quality sunglasses (for the rare but glorious days)
 Small crossbody for tube days

HER LONDON STYLE PRINCIPLE

The palette: charcoal, camel, forest green, burgundy, and one unexpected colour.
 The London formula: one elevated piece + quality basics + a coat that does the talking.
 Never leave without a layer — the weather changes faster than the Tube runs.
 Neighbourhood dressing: Mayfair calls for polish. Shoreditch rewards edge. Notting Hill wants ease.

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

DAY & GALLERIES



Tailored trousers,
quality knit, ankle boot

NOTTING HILL



Midi dress, leather
jacket, loafer, scarf

MAYFAIR EVENING



Blazer, silk blouse,
heeled boot, leather bag

His Edit — London Wardrobe

Sharp when it matters, considered always

CLOTHING — WHAT TO PACK

TOPS & TROUSERS

Quality wool or cashmere overcoat × 1
Well-fitted dark or navy trousers × 2
Quality fitted shirt (white + blue) × 2
Fine knit sweater (merino or wool) × 2
Dark well-fitted jeans × 1

LAYERS & EVENING

Tailored blazer or sport coat × 1
Quality T-shirt (white or grey) × 2
Smart chinos × 1
Leather jacket (Shoreditch credential) × 1
Thermal underlayer (autumn/winter) × 1

SHOES

Chelsea boot (leather) — the London male standard, works everywhere, always
Oxford or Derby shoe (leather) — Mayfair, City, fine dining, theatre
Clean quality sneaker — Shoreditch, Borough Market, South Bank, casual weekends
Loafer — Notting Hill, gallery visits, and smart-casual evenings

ACCESSORIES

WARDROBE DETAILS

Wool or cashmere scarf (essential, not decorative)
Quality leather gloves (autumn/winter)
Leather tote or briefcase

BAGS & EYEWEAR

Compact umbrella (carry every day)
Quality sunglasses
Minimal watch (London appreciates a good watch)

DRESS CODE — BY OCCASION

Daytime / café:

Gallery / museum:

Restaurant dinner:

Theatre / opera:

Quality jeans or chinos, fitted shirt or knit, Chelsea boot or sneaker

Smart casual — London's cultural institutions notice effort

Blazer or quality jacket, leather shoe — most good London restaurants expect this

Smart to formal — the stalls at the Royal Opera House dress properly

OUTFIT INSPIRATION

CITY DAY



Dark jeans, fine knit,
Chelsea boot

SMART CASUAL



Chinos, blazer,
Oxford shoe

EVENING



Trousers, shirt,
overcoat, leather shoe

BEAUTY & TOILETRIES

What to Bring

London's cold, damp air is genuinely dehydrating for skin. Rich moisturiser is your priority. Boots, Space NK, and Liberty Beauty stock exceptional products — worth a visit in their own right.

HER BEAUTY BAG

Rich SPF 30 daily moisturiser (UV still present in winter)
 Hydrating serum (London air is drying)
 Long-wear foundation or tinted moisturiser
 Mascara (waterproof for rain)
 Classic red or berry lip — very London
 Understated, cool-weather perfume
 Hand cream (cold air dehydrates fast)
 Dry shampoo (humidity affects hair)

HIS GROOMING KIT

Rich SPF 30 moisturiser (year-round)
 Hydrating lip balm (cold wind)
 Cologne (cool and woody for the season)
 Beard oil or quality balm
 Hair product (humidity-resistant)
 Hand cream (underrated in cold weather)
 Face wash (city pollution is real)
 Eye cream (late London nights)

ESSENTIALS & SMART TRAVEL

TECH & PRACTICALITIES

UK Type G adapter (3-pin — essential)
 Portable phone charger
 Compact umbrella (carry daily, no exceptions)
 Oyster card or contactless card (Tube and buses)

THE EXTRAS THAT MATTER

British pounds cash (some markets and pubs)
 Offline maps (Tube signal is non-existent)
 Travel insurance docs
 Light day pack (gallery shops are dangerous)

WHAT NOT TO PACK — EVER

Only summer clothes — London weather will humiliate you within 24 hours of arrival
 Uncomfortable shoes — London is a walking city and the pavements are unforgiving
 Loud tourist clothing — London's best experiences are accessed by blending in, not standing out
 A single bag for all occasions — London requires a day bag and an evening option at minimum
 Shorts as evening attire — this reads as tourist even in summer; smart casual is the floor
 Cheap umbrella — a gust on the Embankment will destroy it; invest in a Fulton or Blunt

PACKING STRATEGY & CHECKLIST

Arriving in London

Stay in Mayfair, Marylebone, Chelsea, or Notting Hill — proximity to culture matters enormously.
 Get an Oyster card at any Tube station on arrival — the single best investment of your trip.
 Book your restaurant tables before you fly — Brat, Ottolenghi, J Sheekey, and Sketch fill weeks ahead.
 Allow one full unplanned day — London's greatest experiences are stumbled into, not scheduled.
 The National Gallery, V&A, Tate Modern, and British Museum are all free. Plan accordingly.

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London rewards the curious, the well-dressed, and the patient. Be all three.

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MASTER PACKING CHECKLIST

Print this page and tick each item as you pack.

HER CLOTHING	HIS CLOTHING	BEAUTY & GROOMING	EXTRAS & DOCS
☐ Trench coat × 1 ☐ Wide-leg trousers × 2 ☐ Silk/quality blouse × 2 ☐ Fine knit/turtleneck × 2 ☐ Midi dress × 1 ☐ Dark jeans × 1 ☐ Blazer × 1 ☐ Quality tee × 2 ☐ Leather jacket × 1 ☐ Thermal underlayer × 1 ☐ Ankle boot ☐ Ballet flat/loafer ☐ White sneaker ☐ Heeled boot ☐ Compact umbrella ☐ Structured bag	☐ Wool overcoat × 1 ☐ Dark trousers × 2 ☐ Quality shirt × 2 ☐ Fine knit × 2 ☐ Dark jeans × 1 ☐ Tailored blazer × 1 ☐ Quality tee × 2 ☐ Smart chinos × 1 ☐ Leather jacket × 1 ☐ Thermal underlayer × 1 ☐ Chelsea boot ☐ Oxford/Derby shoe ☐ Clean sneaker ☐ Loafer ☐ Compact umbrella ☐ Leather tote	☐ SPF 30 moisturiser ☐ Hydrating serum ☐ Foundation/tinted SPF ☐ Waterproof mascara ☐ Bold lip colour ☐ Perfume/cologne ☐ Hand cream ☐ Dry shampoo ☐ Beard oil/balm ☐ Hair product ☐ Lip balm ☐ Face wash ☐ Eye cream ☐ Compact mirror ☐ Power bank ☐ Deodorant	☐ Oyster card ☐ GBP cash ☐ UK adapter (Type G) ☐ Passport ☐ Travel insurance ☐ Compact umbrella ☐ Offline maps ☐ Light day pack ☐ Kindle / book ☐ Camera ☐ Hotel confirmations ☐ Pain reliever ☐ Plasters ☐ Antihistamine ☐ Earplugs ☐ Eye mask